

WREL

Intel has powered a netbook over thin air, using a Wireless Resonant Energy Link (WREL). Right now, though, this is just limited to a few watts over a metre

Windows in, Linux out?

NVIDIA's Tegra prefers Windows CE over Android or Linux for its ARM-based netbooks. Tegra play HD video quite well—something that Android can't do, because it renders video using Java, not the hardware.

Feature

A chat that occurred on our IRC server between two friends — uncensored (well almost)

- <A> if only the 7-inch screens were actually usable
 oh they are, so long as you don't surf
 everything else is fine on them
<A> 800x480
<A> dark age stuff
 heh they should get 10 inch resolution on the 7 inch
<A> i'm waiting for the ARM netbooks
<A> with android
 which might work... or might not
<A> it's cool because android is designed for small screens
<A> unlike windows or linux distros
 betcha microsoft designs WM for netbooks
 or at least their own netbook OS
<A> doesn't look like they are doing that for 7
<A> which is surprisingly snappy, btw
<A> the whole netbook approach is arseways anyway
 how so?
<A> they should have said let's make a big smartphone
<A> not a small PC
 nah
 you are arseways
 tell me 10 things you do without typing
<A> i'm not saying ditch the keyboard
<A> i'm not talking design at all
<A> i'm saying use ARM
<A> and use an OS that is meant for small screens
<A> and apps that are meant for small screens
 nah, ARM can't run OSes to do what we want
<A> but the whole point of a netbook is net + basic office stuff
<A> at least the cheapest ones
 so imagine you using Symbian ALL the time
<A> my phone's symbian.. it does docs, and internet, and other misc shite
 there's a certain speed you just cannot live without
 and a certain screen size
 and that's quickly looking to be 9/10 inches
<A> yeah, and even at that size, ARM is capable of doing wonders if someone writes an OS around it
 but apps aren't available
<A> the x86+windows is the easy way out
 in this day and age, no tech company wants to invest time and money into something that will come out in 3 years even
 even Apple took that easy way out
 why not others :)
 look at the need
 the need is "computing on the go"
 not mobile on the go
 or powerful mobiles
 people want to be able to compute ... and the way we know how to compute today is the notebook
<A> yeah but how much computing is computing?
<A> ARM is perfectly capable of everyday use
<A> and has built-in hardware mods for video and audio
 you seriously think ARM would have enough power to run something like microsoft office
<A> not MS office, but the Next Mobile Office Suite (TM)
 no one wants that
 like no one wants to shift from outlook
 try teaching the masses how to use irfanview instead of MS Picture and Image viewer
 you cannot break MS dominance that easily
<A> course not... but that doesn't mean everyone should just say "ah **** it" and give up
 but right now at least netbook = cheap alternative to notebook, which = MS OS
<A> people train themselves to learn their mobile OSes quickly enough
<A> assuming the OS is decent
<A> why not netbooks?
<A> why not on a portable device that does everything they want it to?
 because humanity still associates them both as different tasks
 mobile = texting, calling and fun
 laptop = work, chat, mail and fun
 anyway i still think netbooks will remain MS / Linux dominated, simply because everyone wants and buys a PC
<A> android is linux-based though
 sure but a lame version
<A> all they have to do is make it run regular linux apps
 oh like that's gonna happen overnight
<A> no, but start work
<A> analysis paralysis is a dangerous thing
 like Google is gonna enable yum install lol
<A> Google doesn't have to
<A> android = lin = open source
 fine, let's wait and watch...

For more chats like this one, you can go to [irc://irc.thinkdigit.com](http://irc.thinkdigit.com), and chat live with other readers, as well as members of the Digit team.



Moblin's M-Zone page takes a leaf out of your mobile phone's "Home" screen, with a quick overview of the stuff you've done recently

Teh unsolvable interwebz

Ironically, the one thing 7-inch netbooks won't be able to do — not while they're 800 x 480, anyway — is provide a great internet experience. Most sites are designed for screens that are at least 1024 pixels wide, so you're going to see ugly horizontal

scrollbars as you surf. And since 800 x 480 is way bigger than your mobile phone's screen, the mobile layouts for the sites will look quite silly.

It's wishful thinking to expect that web developers are going to modify their sites just for a bunch of netbook users—no matter

how much the world loves netbooks—so unless the 7-inch, 1024 x 600 LCD becomes much cheaper, netbook manufacturers will either have to apply custom stylesheets to make sites look right, or just let you suffer.

But even badly designed sites are not going to stop anyone.

Fight!

Unbeknownst to you, this topic has been the subject of a few heated IRC debates, even within the Digit team. While some of us are rooting for the ARM-based underdog, others don't see the merit in trying to redo the netbook — "try getting professionals to ditch Outlook", they say. As long as Intel continues to improve on the Atom (and any x86 platform that succeeds it), there's no compelling reason to switch to a completely alien platform.

But we train ourselves to use our smartphones quickly enough — why not on a cheap netbook, as long as it does everything we want it to?

It all comes down to you: do you want to stick to your Windows or Linux netbook, or will you jump ship to an Android netbook that'll do all that you need it to, only in different programs? The forums, as always, are open. 